

Industree Foundation

Founded: 2000

Sector: Women's Economic Empowerment, Artisan Livelihoods, Creative Manufacturing, Climate Resilience

Industree Foundation was established in 2000 by Neelam Chhiber in Bengaluru to address the systemic barriers keeping India's artisan workforce — predominantly women — locked in informality, low wages, and vulnerability.

Working at the intersection of equity, gender, and climate, Industree builds self-sustaining women-owned producer collectives, connects them to mainstream national and global value chains, and exits once communities are self-sufficient. Its proprietary 6C Framework — Collective, Capacity, Commerce, Capital, Compliance, Community — is now a globally recognised model for ownership-based enterprise formation.

Women's Informality & Low Wages

Market Access for Artisan Producers

Gender & Climate Vulnerability

Livelihood & Enterprise Ownership

Supply Chain Transparency & Traceability

Industree Initiatives

6C Framework

Industree's proprietary model for forming women-owned producer collectives: Collective formation → Capacity building → Commerce linkage → Capital access → Compliance (social security, labour rights) → Community integration. Proven across four states; now licensed to 84+ partner organisations as a replication toolkit.

Mission Creative Million

Industree's flagship scale initiative targeting one million artisan producers — delivering regular income, increased wages, financial stability, and improved social security. Combines deep, broad, and light handholding tracks to reach communities at different stages of enterprise readiness.

Regionals — Incubator-Accelerator Programme

Industree's programme enabling other social enterprises to adopt and implement the 6C Framework in their own geographies. Provides mentoring, technical assistance, and market linkage support — operationalising Neelam's conviction that scale requires enabling others, not direct organisational growth alone.

Flourish (flourish.shop)

100% producer-owned e-commerce platform enabling artisan collectives to sell directly to global customers. Industree manages marketing and administration; all revenue accrues to producers. Expanding to Flourish US to empower artisan communities worldwide.

PIE Platform (Platform for Inclusive Entrepreneurship)

Technology-enabled platform extending Industree's ecosystem model beyond its direct reach — connecting women producers, market intermediaries, capital providers, and skill-building partners through a networked digital infrastructure.

Global Supply Chain Integration

Industree has connected rural women-led collectives (Ekta — apparel and embroidery; GreenKraft — sustainable home products) to IKEA, H&M Home, and Future Group. Ensures fair wages, social security coverage, no forced labour, and traceable, compliant supply chains meeting global ethical procurement standards.

Core Impact Areas



Increased and regular incomes



Women's empowerment at home and work



Decent and equitable work conditions



Resilience to life crisis



Improved standard of living for the next generation



Climate action